

A L^AT_EX Template for Transportation Research Board Annual Meeting Papers

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1 ABSTRACT

2 For the 2027 Transportation Research Board (TRB) Annual Meeting, TRB has updated their re-
3 quirements for the submission process. This template offers a pragmatic starting point for authors
4 using LaTeX (and related literate programming tools) while matching TRB conventions. Note that
5 the Abstract now must be formatted as a structured abstract per TRB guidance and it must be less
6 than 300 words. The content below summarizes what each section of the structured abstract should
7 include based on TRB's Instructions For Authors.

8
9 **Objectives:** In 2–3 sentences, define the specific transportation problem and context. State the
10 objective of this paper and the specific need being addressed. Do not include broad background or
11 literature review content.

12
13 **Methods:** In 3–4 sentences, describe the study design and technical rigor. Identify data type(s),
14 source(s), and scope (e.g., sample size, time frame, and geography). Summarize the analytical
15 approach used to evaluate the objective.

16
17 **Findings:** In 2–3 sentences, report the most important results. Indicate whether results are sig-
18 nificant based on statistical testing, sensitivity analysis, validation, and/or rigorous qualitative
19 assessment.

20
21 **Novelty:** In 1–2 sentences, clearly state the novel transportation contribution of this work.

22
23 **Practical Applications:** In 1–2 sentences, explain how findings inform transportation practice
24 and/or policy, including specific implementation considerations or operational contexts.

1 INTRODUCTION

2 The Transportation Research Board (TRB) currently requires submissions of full papers to be
3 considered for presentation at the TRB Annual Meeting (*I*). The Instructions For Authors website
4 (<https://trb.secure-platform.com/a/page/TRBPaperReview>) outlines specific requirements for
5 submissions. Initial submissions are PDFs, while accepted papers for the *Transportation Research*
6 *Record* may require Microsoft Office formats. Manuscripts must be line-numbered; captions are
7 bold with TRB-specific punctuation; in-text citations are numbered and the reference list is ordered
8 numerically. See the author information online at <https://trb.secure-platform.com/a/page/TRBPaperReview>.

10 We assume basic familiarity with $\text{\LaTeX}$ and `bibtex`. As literate programming becomes
11 more common, the template may evolve to support additional workflows.

12 History

13 David R. Pritchard (2) released the original template in 2009 and updated it in 2011. Gregory
14 S. Macfarlane (3) extended it in 2012 (Sweave integration and auto counts). C. Ross Wang (4)
15 automated total word count calculation and improved formatting in 2015, added GitHub releases
16 in 2016, and provided $\text{\TeX}$ -only variants in 2017 (https://github.com/chiehrosswang/TRB_LaTeX
17 `_tex`) and an RNW version (https://github.com/chiehrosswang/TRB_LaTeX_rnw). The 2019 and
18 2025 updates focused on the $\text{\TeX}$ -only version: the 2019 update improved Overleaf compatibility,
19 while the 2025 update enhanced word-counting and authorship blocks.

20 FEATURES

21 This template targets quick and TRB-compliant manuscript assembly (*I*).

22 Title Page

23 The class provides a custom `\maketitle` that prints authors (via `\TRBauthor`), a word count
24 (with tables counted as 250 words each by default), and the submission date. Word counting uses
25 `texcount` via shell escape; compile with `--shell-escape` (see the BUILD section).

26 Page Layout

27 Margins are 1 in. The running header shows authors (set with `\AuthorHeaders`) at the left and
28 the page number at the right. Headings and spacing follow TRB conventions.

29 Line Numbers

30 Line numbering uses the `lineno` package and resets each page. Blank lines are not numbered. The
31 `numbered` class option enables line numbers.

32 MORE FEATURES

33 Captions

34 Figure 1 shows a Gumbel distribution as an example. Figure captions use sentence case. Table
35 captions use Title Case and function as a short title. Table 1 summarizes the template history. Both
36 Figure and Table captions are bold.

37 Bibliography

38 Use `trb.bst`. The command `\citep{}` prints authors with the reference number; `\cite{}` prints
39 only the number. References appear in numerical order.

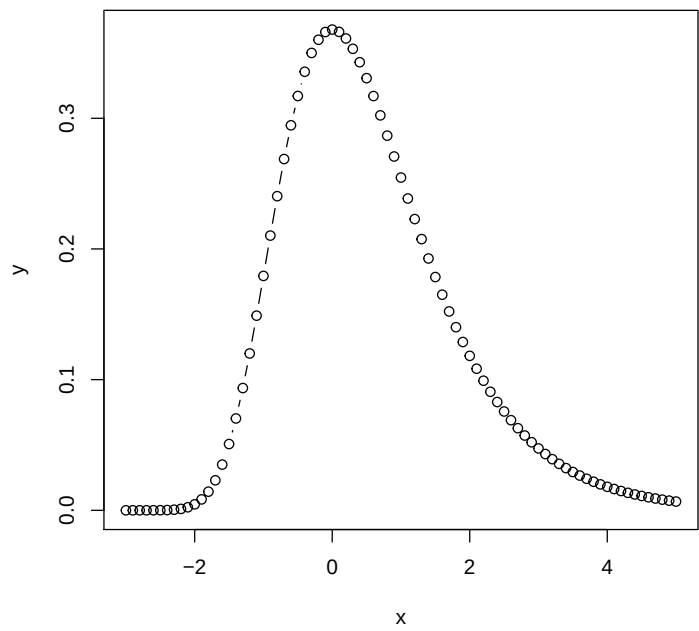


FIGURE 1 Example figure illustrating the caption style and counting on the title page.

TABLE 1 A History of this Template

Version	Date	Author	Contributions
1.0	Sep 2009	Pritchard	Initial work
1.1	Mar 2011	Pritchard	Caption fixes
2.0	Mar 2012	Macfarlane	Automation, documentation
2.1	Jul 2015	Wang	More automation and formatting
2.1.1	Jan 2016	Wang	Minor modifications; GitHub
2.1.1 Lite	Jun 2017	Wang	T _E X-only template
3.1	Jun 2017	Wang	Added <code>trbunofficial.cls</code>
3.1 Lite	Jun 2017	Wang	Added <code>trbunofficial.cls</code>
4.0 Lite	Jul 2019	Wang	Word-count updates for Overleaf
5.0 Lite	Aug 2025	Wang	Word-count improvements*

* Total counts include: Title, front matter, body texts, headers, captions, references. Total word counts do not include text in tables (each table is automatically counted as 250 words).

1 Examples include Bierlaire, Bierlaire, Garrow et al., Koppelman and Garrow (5–8) and

2 grouped numeric citations (5, 7, 8).

1 Equations

2 Equations are left aligned with no extra indentation. Below is the Intelligent Driver Model (from
3 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Intelligent_driver_model).

$$4 \quad \dot{x}_\alpha = \frac{dx_\alpha}{dt} = v_\alpha, \quad (1)$$

$$5 \quad \dot{v}_\alpha = \frac{dv_\alpha}{dt} = a \left(1 - \left(\frac{v_\alpha}{v_0} \right)^\delta - \left(\frac{s^*(v_\alpha, \Delta v_\alpha)}{s_\alpha} \right)^2 \right), \quad (2)$$

$$6 \quad s^*(v_\alpha, \Delta v_\alpha) = s_0 + v_\alpha T + \frac{v_\alpha \Delta v_\alpha}{2\sqrt{ab}}. \quad (3)$$

7 Referencing Sections by Custom Names

8 Because this template does not use section numbering, referencing sections directly can be difficult.
9 To address this, you can create hyperlinks to labeled sections with your own display text using the
10 `\customref` command: `\customref{Displayed Text}{label}`.

11 For example, if you have defined `\label{sec:intro}` for the Introduction section, you can
12 write `\customref{INTRODUCTION section}{sec:intro}` to produce a hyperlink that appears
13 as INTRODUCTION section.

14 CONCLUSION AND BUILD

15 To build with automatic word counting:

16 `latexmk trb_template.tex -pdf -pvc -shell-escape`

17 The `--shell-escape` flag lets `texcount` run for accurate totals.

18 Perl is required for `texcount` (e.g., ActivePerl: <http://www.activestate.com/activeperl/downloads>).
19

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22 `trbunofficial` class that advanced this work.

23 AUTHOR CONTRIBUTIONS

24 The authors confirm contribution to the paper as follows: study conception and design: X. Author,
25 Y. Author; data collection: Y. Author; analysis and interpretation of results: X. Author, Y. Author,
26 Z. Author; draft manuscript preparation: Y. Author, Z. Author. All authors reviewed the results
27 and approved the final version of the manuscript.

28 DECLARATION OF CONFLICTING INTERESTS

29 X. Author is a member of Transportation Research Record's Editorial Board. All other authors
30 declare no potential conflicts of interest with respect to the research, authorship, and publication of
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